

Information Technology Frequently Asked Questions

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1. Purpose

This document collects the questions employees most often ask about Information Technology policies at Beacon Technologies Pvt. Ltd., with short answers. Each answer shows the policy it comes from.

2. Scope

This document covers policies BT-IT-001 to BT-IT-005, and some common questions that also involve other departments. If an answer differs from the policy document, the policy document applies.

3. Questions by Policy

BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q1. What is the minimum password length?

12 characters, with uppercase, lowercase, a number and a special character.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q2. How often do I need to change my password?

Every 90 days. You cannot reuse your last 5 passwords.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q3. My account got locked. What do I do?

It unlocks automatically after 30 minutes. For faster help, contact the IT Service Desk at extension 4000.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q4. Is MFA required when I work from home?

Yes. MFA is required for the VPN, email and all main systems at all times.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q5. Can I share my password with my manager to cover while I am on leave?

No. Passwords must never be shared. Ask your manager to request delegated access from IT.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q6. Where should I store my passwords?

In the approved password manager, BeaconVault. Do not store them in your browser or in documents.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

Q7. I lost my phone with the authenticator app. What now?

Contact the IT Service Desk immediately so your MFA can be reset and your account protected.

Reference: BT-IT-001 Password Policy

BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q8. When will I get my laptop?

On your date of joining.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q9. How often are laptops replaced?

Every 4 years, or earlier if the device fails and cannot be repaired.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q10. Can I use my personal laptop for work if mine is being repaired?

No. IT will provide a replacement within 2 working days.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q11. My laptop was stolen. What should I do?

Report it to the IT Service Desk immediately, within 2 hours at most, and file a police complaint. You normally will not be charged for a first theft case with an FIR.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q12. Can I carry my laptop in checked luggage on a flight?

No. It must be carried in your hand luggage.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q13. Can I plug in a USB pen drive?

Not by default. USB storage is blocked unless IT approves an exception.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

Q14. When do I return my laptop if I resign?

By your last working day.

Reference: BT-IT-002 Laptop Policy

BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q15. Do I need the VPN when I work from home?

Yes, whenever you access internal systems such as file servers, code repositories, the Finance Portal and the People Portal.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q16. Do I need the VPN to read my email?

No, but you need MFA to log in.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q17. Can I use the VPN on my personal laptop?

No. VPN is only allowed on company-issued laptops.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q18. Can I use cafe or airport Wi-Fi?

Yes, only with the VPN connected.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q19. How long can I stay connected?

Up to 12 hours per session. You are disconnected after 30 minutes of inactivity.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q20. Can I work remotely from another country using the VPN?

Not as remote work. For approved business travel abroad, apply to the Information Security Officer at least 3 working days in advance.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

Q21. How long does a vendor's VPN access last?

A maximum of 90 days, after which the sponsor must renew it.

Reference: BT-IT-003 VPN Policy

BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy**Q22. How do I get new software installed?**

Raise a request on the IT Service Desk portal. Free software from the Beacon Software Catalogue is installed within 2 working days.

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

Q23. What if the tool I need is not in the catalogue?

Submit a request with a business reason. IT Security will review it within 5 working days.

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

Q24. Do I have admin rights on my laptop?

Not by default. You can request temporary admin rights for 30 days. Developers can get up to 90 days with manager approval.

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

Q25. Can I use a free online tool to share company files?

Only if it has been security-approved. Do not upload company data to unapproved tools.

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

Q26. Who approves paid software?

Your reporting manager approves it. If it costs more than ₹25,000 per year, the Department Head must also approve (BT-FIN-005).

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

Q27. Can I use my own VPN app on my laptop?

No. Only Beacon Secure Connect is allowed (see BT-IT-003).

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

Q28. What happens if I install unapproved software?

IT will remove it and inform your manager. Repeated violations may lead to disciplinary action.

Reference: BT-IT-004 Software Installation Policy

BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy**Q29. How quickly must I report a security incident?**

Within 2 hours of noticing it.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

Q30. Who do I report to?

The IT Service Desk (extension 4000) or security@beacon-tech.example. After hours, call the Security Hotline at extension 4999.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

Q31. I clicked a suspicious link. Will I get in trouble?

No, if you report it promptly. Delays or hiding it are the problem, not the mistake.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

Q32. My laptop was stolen at the airport. What happens?

Report within 2 hours. IT will lock and wipe it remotely within 1 hour of your report. File a police complaint and share the FIR copy.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

Q33. What should I do with a phishing email?

Use the "Report Phishing" button. Do not forward it or reply.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

Q34. My corporate card was lost. Is that an IT matter?

Inform your bank and Finance within 2 hours (BT-FIN-003), and also tell the Security team if it was stored on a device.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

Q35. How often is security training required?

Within 30 days of joining and every year after that.

Reference: BT-IT-005 Security Incident Policy

4. Questions That Involve More Than One Department

Q36. Can I use my personal laptop to work from home?

No. Only the company-issued laptop may be used for remote work, and VPN is only allowed on company laptops.

Reference: BT-IT-002, BT-IT-003, BT-HR-003

Q37. Do I need the VPN to submit a reimbursement claim from home?

Yes. The Beacon Finance Portal is an internal system, so you must connect to the company VPN when accessing it from outside the office.

Reference: BT-IT-003, BT-FIN-002

Q38. Who approves a software licence that costs ₹30,000 per year?

Your reporting manager and the Department Head approve it, with review by the Head of IT. A purchase order is needed because the amount is above ₹10,000.

Reference: BT-IT-004, BT-FIN-005

Q39. My laptop was stolen during a business trip. What should I do and will I have to pay?

Report it to the IT Service Desk immediately and within 2 hours at most. IT will lock and wipe the laptop within 1 hour of your report. File a police complaint (FIR). For a first case with an FIR copy, no cost is recovered from you.

Reference: BT-IT-002, BT-IT-005, BT-FIN-001

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